

Finding Additional Shortcuts

Working efficiently in an editing environment takes practice, but it also takes intention. When you're learning to work with code, try to notice the things you do repeatedly. Any action you take in your editor likely has a shortcut; if you're clicking menu items to carry out editing tasks, look for the shortcuts for those actions. If you're switching between your keyboard and mouse frequently, look for the navigation shortcuts that keep you from reaching for your mouse so often.

You can see all the keyboard shortcuts in VS Code by clicking **Code** and then **Preferences**, and then choosing **Keyboard Shortcuts**. You can use the search bar to find a particular shortcut, or you can scroll through the list to find shortcuts that might help you work more efficiently.

Remember, it's better to focus on the code that you're working on, and avoid spending too much time on the tools you're using.

Other Text Editors and IDEs

You'll hear about and see people using a number of other text editors. Most of them can be configured to help you in the same way you've customized VS Code. Here's a small selection of text editors you might hear about.

IDLE

IDLE is a text editor that's included with Python. It's a little less intuitive to work with than other, more modern editors. However, you'll see references to it in other tutorials aimed at beginners, so you might want to give it a try.

Geany

Geany is a simple text editor that displays all of your output in a separate terminal window, which helps you become comfortable using terminals. *Geany* has a very minimalist interface, but it's powerful enough that a significant number of experienced programmers still use it.

If you find VS Code too distracting and full of too many features, consider using *Geany* instead.

Sublime Text

Sublime Text is another minimalist editor that you should consider using if you find VS Code too busy. *Sublime Text* has a really clean interface and is known for working well even on very large files. It's an editor that will get out of your way and let you focus on the code you're writing.

Sublime Text has an unlimited free trial, but it's not free or open source. If you decide you like it and can afford to purchase a full license, you should do so. The purchase is a one-time fee; it's not a software subscription.